

## Chapter 2 Definitions: 2023 FBC - Residential, 8<sup>th</sup> edition | UpCodes

### Chapter 2 Definitions

#### Section R201 General

##### R201.1 Scope

Unless otherwise expressly stated, the following words and terms shall, for the purposes of this code, have the meanings indicated in this chapter.

##### R201.2 Interchangeability

Words used in the present tense include the future; words in the masculine gender include the feminine and neuter; the singular number includes the plural and the plural, the singular.

##### R201.3 Terms Defined in Other Codes

Where terms are not defined in this code such terms shall have the meanings ascribed in other code publications of the *Florida Building Commission*.

##### R201.4 Terms Not Defined

Where terms are not defined through the methods authorized by this section, such terms shall have ordinarily accepted meanings such as the context implies.

#### Section R202 Definitions

##### Access (To)

That which enables a device, appliance or equipment to be reached by *ready access* or by a means that first requires the removal or movement of a panel, door or similar obstruction.

##### [RB] Accessory Structure

A structure that is accessory to and incidental to that of the *dwelling(s)* and that is located on the same *lot*.

##### [RB] Addition

An extension or increase in floor area, number of stories or height of a building or structure.

##### [RB] Adhered Stone or Masonry Veneer

Stone or masonry veneer secured and supported through the adhesion of an *approved* bonding material applied to an *approved* backing.

##### Air Admittance Valve

A one-way valve designed to allow air into the plumbing drainage system where a negative pressure develops in the piping. This device shall close by gravity and seal the terminal under conditions of zero differential pressure (no flow conditions) and under positive internal pressure.

##### Air Barrier

See Section R202 of the *Florida Building Code, Energy Conservation*.

##### Air Break (Drainage System)

An arrangement where a discharge pipe from a fixture, *appliance* or device drains indirectly into a receptor below the flood-level rim of the receptor and above the trap seal.

##### Air Circulation, Forced

A means of providing space conditioning utilizing movement of air through ducts or plenums by mechanical means.

##### Air-Conditioning System

A system that consists of heat exchangers, blowers, filters, supply, exhaust and return-air systems, and shall include any apparatus installed in connection therewith.

**Air Gap, Drainage System**

The unobstructed vertical distance through free atmosphere between the outlet of a waste pipe and the flood-level rim of the fixture or receptor into which it is discharging.

**Air Gap, Water-Distribution System**

The unobstructed vertical distance through free atmosphere between the lowest opening from a water supply discharge to the flood-level rim of a plumbing fixture.

**[RB] Air-Impermeable Insulation**

An insulation having an air permance equal to or less than 0.02 L/s-m<sup>2</sup> at 75 Pa pressure differential as tested in accordance with ASTM E2178 or E283.

**[RB] Alteration**

Any construction, retrofit or renovation to an existing structure other than repair or addition that requires a permit. Also, a change in a building, electrical, gas, mechanical or plumbing system that involves an extension, addition or change to the arrangement, type or purpose of the original installation that requires a permit.

**[RB] Alternating Tread Device**

A device that has a series of steps between 50 and 70 degrees (0.87 and 1.22 rad) from horizontal, usually attached to a center support rail in an alternating manner so that the user does not have both feet on the same level at the same time.

**[RB] Anchored Stone or Masonry Veneer**

Stone or masonry veneer secured with *approved* mechanical fasteners to an *approved* backing.

**Anchors**

See "*Supports*."

**Antisiphon**

A term applied to valves or mechanical devices that eliminate siphonage.

**Appliance**

A device or apparatus that is manufactured and designed to utilize energy and for which this code provides specific requirements.

**Applicable Governing Body**

A city, county, state, state agency or other political government subdivision or entity authorized to administer and enforce the provisions of this code, as adopted or amended. Also applies to administrative authority.

**[RB] Approved**

Acceptable to the *building official*.

**[RB] Approved Agency**

An established and recognized agency that is regularly engaged in conducting tests or furnishing inspection services, where such agency has been *approved* by the building official.

**Architect**

A Florida-registered architect.

**[RB] Aspect Ratio**

The ratio of longest to shortest perpendicular dimensions, or for wall sections, the ratio of height to length.

**[RB] Attic**

The unfinished space between the ceiling assembly and the *roof assembly*.

**[RB] Attic, Habitable**

A finished or unfinished area, not considered a *story*, complying with all of the following requirements:

1. The occupiable floor area is not less than 70 square feet (6.5 m<sup>2</sup>), in accordance with Section R304.
2. The occupiable floor area has a ceiling height in accordance with Section R305.
3. The occupiable space is enclosed by the roof assembly above, knee walls (if applicable) on the sides and the floor-ceiling assembly below.

**Backflow, Drainage**

A reversal of flow in the drainage system.

**Backflow Preventer**

A backflow prevention assembly, a backflow prevention device or other means or method to prevent backflow into the potable water supply.

**Backflow Preventer, Reduced-Pressure-Zone Type**

A backflow-prevention device consisting of two independently acting check valves, internally force loaded to a normally closed position and separated by an intermediate chamber (or zone) in which there is an automatic relief means of venting to atmosphere internally loaded to a normally open position between two tightly closing shutoff valves and with means for testing for tightness of the checks and opening of relief means.

**Backflow, Water Distribution**

The flow of water or other liquids into the potable water-supply piping from any sources other than its intended source. Backsiphonage is one type of backflow.

**Backpressure**

Pressure created by any means in the water distribution system that by being in excess of the pressure in the water supply mains causes a potential backflow condition.

**Backpressure, Low Head**

A pressure less than or equal to 4.33 psi (29.88 kPa) or the pressure exerted by a 10-foot (3048 mm) column of water.

**Backsiphonage**

The flowing back of used or contaminated water from piping into a potable water-supply pipe due to a negative pressure in such pipe.

**Backwater Valve**

A device installed in a drain or pipe to prevent backflow of sewage.

**Balanced Ventilation**

Any combination of concurrently operating mechanical exhaust and mechanical supply whereby the total mechanical exhaust airflow rate is within 10% of the total mechanical supply airflow rate.

**[RB] Basement**

A *story* that is not a *story above grade plane* (see "*Story above grade plane*").

**[RE] Basement Wall**

The opaque portion of a wall that encloses one side of a *basement* and has an average below *grade* wall area that is 50 percent or more of the total opaque and nonopaque area of that enclosing side.

**[RB] Basic Wind Speed**

Three-second gust speed at 33 feet (10 058 mm) above the ground in Exposure C (see Section R301.2.1) as given in Figure R301.2(4).

**Bathroom Group**

A group of fixtures, including or excluding a bidet, consisting of a water closet, lavatory, and bathtub or shower. Such fixtures are located together on the same floor level.

**Bend**

A drainage fitting, designed to provide a change in direction of a drain pipe of less than the angle specified by the amount necessary to establish the desired slope of the line (see "*Elbow*" and "*Sweep*").

**Boiler**

A self-contained *appliance* from which hot water is circulated for heating purposes and then returned to the boiler, and that operates at water pressures not exceeding 160 pounds per square inch gage (psig) (1102 kPa gauge) and at water temperatures not exceeding 250°F (121°C).

**[RB] Bond Beam**

A horizontal grouted element within masonry in which reinforcement is embedded.

**[RB] Braced Wall Line**

A straight line through the building plan that represents the location of the lateral resistance provided by the wall bracing.

**[RB] Braced Wall Line, Continuously Sheathed**

A *braced wall line* with structural sheathing applied to all sheathable surfaces including the areas above and below openings.

**[RB] Braced Wall Panel**

A full-height section of wall constructed to resist in-plane shear loads through interaction of framing members, sheathing material and anchors. The panel's length meets the requirements of its particular bracing method, and contributes toward the total amount of bracing required along its *braced wall line* in accordance with Section R602.3.

**Branch**

Any part of the piping system other than a riser, main or stack.

**Branch, Fixture**

See "*Fixture branch, drainage*."

**Branch, Horizontal**

See "*Horizontal branch, drainage*."

**Branch Interval**

A vertical measurement of distance, 8 feet (2438 mm) or more in *developed length*, between the connections of horizontal branches to a drainage stack. Measurements are taken down the stack from the highest horizontal branch connection.

**Branch, Main**

A water-distribution pipe that extends horizontally off a main or riser to convey water to branches or fixture groups.

**Branch, Vent**

A vent connecting two or more individual vents with a vent stack or stack vent.

**BTU/h**

The *listed* maximum capacity of an *appliance*, absorption unit or burner expressed in British thermal units input per hour.

**[RB] Building**

Building shall mean any one- and two-family dwelling or portion thereof, including *townhouses*, that is used, or designed or intended to be used for human habitation, for living, sleeping, cooking or eating purposes, or any combination thereof, and shall include

*accessory structures* thereto.

**Building Drain**

The lowest piping that collects the discharge from all other drainage piping inside the house and extends 30 inches (762 mm) in *developed length* of pipe, beyond the *exterior walls* and conveys the drainage to the *building sewer*.

**[RB] Building, Existing**

Existing building is a building erected prior to the adoption of this code, or one for which a legal building *permit* has been issued.

**[RB] Building-Integrated Photovoltaic Product**

A building product that incorporates *photovoltaic modules* and functions as a component of the building envelope.

**Building-Integrated Photovoltaic Roof Panel**

A photovoltaic panel that functions as a component of the building envelope.

**[RB] Building Line**

The line established by law, beyond which a building shall not extend, except as specifically provided by law.

**[RB] Building Official**

The officer or other designated authority charged with the administration and enforcement of this code.

**Building Sewer**

That part of the drainage system that extends from the end of the *building drain* and conveys its discharge to a public sewer, private sewer, individual sewage-disposal system or other point of disposal.

**[RE] Building Thermal Envelope**

The *basement walls*, *exterior walls*, floor, roof and any other building element that enclose *conditioned spaces*. (Also see Section R202 of the *Florida Building Code, Energy Conservation*.)

**[RB] Built-Up Roof Covering**

Two or more layers of felt cemented together and surfaced with a cap sheet, mineral aggregate, smooth coating or similar surfacing material.

**[RB] Cap Plate**

The top plate of the double top plates used in structural insulated panel (SIP) construction. The cap plate is cut to match the panel thickness such that it overlaps the wood structural panel facing on both sides.

**Carbon Monoxide Alarm**

A device for the purpose of detecting carbon monoxide, that produces a distinct audible alarm, and is listed or labeled with the appropriate standard, either ANSI/UL 2034 *Standard for Single and Multiple Station CO Alarms*, or UL 2075, *Gas and Vapor Detector Sensor*, in accordance with its application.

**[RB] Ceiling Height**

The clear vertical distance from the finished floor to the finished ceiling.

**[RB] Cement Plaster**

A mixture of portland or blended cement, portland cement or blended cement and hydrated lime, masonry cement or plastic cement and aggregate and other *approved* materials as specified in this code.

**[MP] Chimney**

A primary vertical structure containing one or more flues, for the purpose of carrying gaseous products of combustion and air from a fuel-burning *appliance* to the outside atmosphere.

**Chimney Connector**

A pipe that connects a fuel-burning *appliance* to a chimney.

## **Chimney Types**

### **Residential-Type Appliance**

An *approved* chimney for removing the products of combustion from fuel-burning, residential-type *appliances* producing combustion gases not in excess of 1,000°F (538°C) under normal operating conditions, and capable of producing combustion gases of 1,400°F (760°C) during intermittent forces firing for periods up to 1 hour. All temperatures shall be measured at the *appliance* flue outlet. Residential-type *appliance* chimneys include masonry and factory-built types.

### **Circuit Vent**

A vent that connects to a horizontal drainage branch and vents two traps to not more than eight traps or trapped fixtures connected into a battery.

### **Circulating Hot Water System**

A specifically designed water distribution system where one or more pumps are operated in the service hot water piping to circulate heated water from the water-heating equipment to fixtures and back to the water-heating equipment.

### **[RB] Cladding**

The exterior materials that cover the surface of the building envelope that is directly loaded by the wind.

### **[MP] Cleanout**

An access opening in the drainage system utilized for the removal of obstructions. Types of cleanouts include a removable plug or cap, and a removable fixture or fixture trap.

### **[RE] Climate Zone**

See Section R202 of the *Florida Building Code, Energy Conservation*.

### **[RB] Closet**

A small room or chamber used for storage.

### **Collection Pipe**

Unpressurized pipe used within the collection system that drains on-site nonpotable water or rainwater to a storage tank by gravity.

### **Combination Waste and Vent System**

A specially designed system of waste piping embodying the horizontal wet venting of one or more sinks, lavatories or floor drains by means of a common waste and vent pipe adequately sized to provide free movement of air above the flow line of the drain.

### **[RB] Combustible Material**

Any material not defined as noncombustible.

### **Combustion Air**

The air provided to fuel-burning *equipment* including air for fuel combustion, draft hood dilution and ventilation of the *equipment* enclosure.

### **[CE] Commercial Building**

See Section R202 of the *Florida Building Code, Energy Conservation*.

### **Commission**

Means the Florida Building Commission created as per Section 553.74, *Florida Statutes*.

### **Common Vent**

A single pipe venting two trap arms within the same *branch interval*, either back-to-back or one above the other.

**Condensate**

The liquid that separates from a gas due to a reduction in temperature; for example, water that condenses from flue gases and water that condenses from air circulating through the cooling coil in air conditioning *equipment*.

**Condensing Appliance**

An *appliance* that condenses water generated by the burning of fuels.

**[RB] Conditioned Air**

Air treated to control its temperature, relative humidity or quality.

**[RE] Conditioned Area**

That area within a building provided with heating or cooling systems or *appliances* capable of maintaining, through design or heat loss or gain, 68°F (20°C) during the heating season or 80°F (27°C) during the cooling season, or has a fixed opening directly adjacent to a conditioned area.

**[RE] Conditioned Floor Area**

The horizontal projection of the floors associated with the *conditioned space*.

**[RE] Conditioned Space**

An area, room or space that is enclosed within the building thermal envelope and that is directly heated or cooled or that is indirectly heated or cooled. Spaces are indirectly heated or cooled where they communicate thru openings with conditioned spaces, where they are separated from conditioned spaces by uninsulated walls, floors or ceilings or where they contain uninsulated ducts, piping or other sources of heating or cooling.

**[RB] Construction Documents**

Written, graphic and pictorial documents prepared or assembled for describing the design, location and physical characteristics of the elements of a project necessary for obtaining a building *permit*. Construction drawings shall be drawn to an appropriate scale.

**Contamination**

A high hazard or health hazard impairment of the quality of the potable water that creates an actual hazard to the public health through poisoning or through the spread of disease by sewage, industrial fluids or waste.

**[RE] Continuous Insulation (CI)**

Insulating material that is continuous across all structural members without thermal bridges other than fasteners and service openings. It is installed on the interior or exterior or is integral to any opaque surface of the building envelope.

**Continuous Waste**

A drain from two or more similar adjacent fixtures connected to a single trap.

**Control, Limit**

An automatic control responsive to changes in liquid flow or level, pressure, or temperature for limiting the operation of an *appliance*.

**Control, Primary Safety**

A safety control responsive directly to flame properties that senses the presence or absence of flame and, in event of ignition failure or unintentional flame extinguishment, automatically causes shutdown of mechanical *equipment*.

**Convector**

A system-incorporating heating element in an enclosure in which air enters an opening below the heating element, is heated and leaves the enclosure through an opening located above the heating element.

**Copper Alloy**

A homogeneous mixture of not less than two metals where not less than 50 percent of the finished metal is copper.

**Core**

The lightweight middle section of a structural insulated panel, composed of foam plastic insulation that provides the link between the two facing shells.

**[RB] Corrosion Resistance**

The ability of a material to withstand deterioration of its surface or its properties where exposed to its environment.

**[RB] Court**

A space, open and unobstructed to the sky, located at or above *grade* level on a *lot* and bounded on three or more sides by walls or a building.

**[RB] Cripple Wall**

A framed wall extending from the top of the foundation to the underside of the floor framing of the first *story above grade plane*.

**Cross Connection**

Any connection between two otherwise separate piping systems that allows a flow from one system to the other.

**[RB] Cross-Laminated Timber**

A prefabricated engineered wood product consisting of not less than three layers of solid-sawn lumber or *structural composite lumber* where the adjacent layers are cross-oriented and bonded with structural adhesive to form a solid wood element.

**[RE] Curtain Wall**

See Section R202 of the *Florida Building Code, Energy Conservation*.

**[RB] Dalle Glass**

A decorative composite glazing material made of individual pieces of glass that are embedded in a cast matrix of concrete or epoxy.

**Damper, Volume**

A device that will restrict, retard or direct the flow of air in any duct, or the products of combustion of heat-producing *equipment*, vent connector, vent or chimney.

**[RB] Dead Loads**

The weight of the materials of construction incorporated into the building, including but not limited to walls, floors, roofs, ceilings, stairways, built-in partitions, finishes, cladding, and other similarly incorporated architectural and structural items, and fixed service *equipment*.

**Decorative Cementitious Finish**

A skim coat, as defined in ASTM C926, of Portland cement-based plaster applied to concrete or masonry surfaces intended for cosmetic purposes.

**[RB] Decorative Glass**

A carved, leaded or Dalle glass or glazing material with a purpose that is decorative or artistic, not functional; with coloring, texture or other design qualities or components that cannot be removed without destroying the glazing material; and with a surface, or assembly into which it is incorporated, that is divided into segments.

**[RE] Demand Recirculation Water System**

See Section R202 of the *Florida Building Code, Energy Conservation*.

**Design Professional**

See "*Registered design professional*."

**Developed Length**

The length of a pipeline measured along the center line of the pipe and fittings.

**Diameter**



Unless specifically stated, the term "diameter" is the nominal diameter as designated by the *approved* material standard.

**[RB] Diaphragm**

A horizontal or nearly horizontal system acting to transmit lateral forces to the vertical resisting elements. Where the term "*diaphragm*" is used, it includes horizontal bracing systems.

**Dilution Air**

Air that enters a draft hood or draft regulator and mixes with flue gases.

**Direct System**

A solar thermal system in which the gas or liquid in the solar collector loop is not separated from the load.

**Direct-Vent Appliance**

A fuel-burning *appliance* with a sealed combustion system that draws all air for combustion from the outside atmosphere and discharges all flue gases to the outside atmosphere.

**Draft**

The pressure difference existing between the *appliance* or any component part and the atmosphere, that causes a continuous flow of air and products of combustion through the gas passages of the *appliance* to the atmosphere.

**Induced Draft**

The pressure difference created by the action of a fan, blower or ejector, that is located between the *appliance* and the chimney or vent termination.

**Natural Draft**

The pressure difference created by a vent or chimney because of its height, and the temperature difference between the flue gases and the atmosphere.

**Draft Hood**

A device built into an *appliance*, or a part of the vent connector from an *appliance*, that is designed to provide for the ready escape of the flue gases from the *appliance* in the event of no draft, backdraft or stoppage beyond the draft hood; prevent a backdraft from entering the *appliance*; and neutralize the effect of stack action of the chimney or gas vent on the operation of the *appliance*.

**Draft Regulator**

A device that functions to maintain a desired draft in the *appliance* by automatically reducing the draft to the desired value.

**[RB] Draft Stop**

A material, device or construction installed to restrict the movement of air within open spaces of concealed areas of building components such as crawl spaces, floor-ceiling assemblies, roof-ceiling assemblies and *attics*.

**Drain**

Any pipe that carries soil and water-borne wastes in a building drainage system.

**Drainage Fitting**

A pipe fitting designed to provide connections in the drainage system that have provisions for establishing the desired slope in the system. These fittings are made from a variety of both metals and plastics. The methods of coupling provide for required slope in the system.

**Drain-Back System**

A solar thermal system in which the fluid in the solar collector loop is drained from the collector into a holding tank under prescribed circumstances.

**[BS] Drilled Shaft**

A cast-in-place deep foundation element, also referred to as caisson, drilled pier and bored pile, constructed by drilling a hole (with

or without permanent casing or drilling fluid) into soil or rock and filling it with fluid concrete after the drilling equipment is removed.

**Drilled Shaft, Socketed**

A drilled shaft with a permanent pipe or tube casing that extends down to bedrock and an uncased socket drilled into the bedrock.

**Duct System**

A continuous passageway for the transmission of air that, in addition to ducts, includes duct fittings, dampers, plenums, fans and accessory air-handling *equipment and appliances*.

See also Section R202 of the *Florida Building Code, Energy Conservation*.

**[RB] Dwelling**

Any building that contains one or two *dwelling units* used, intended, or designed to be built, used, rented, leased, let or hired out to be occupied, or that are occupied for living purposes.

**[RB] Dwelling Unit**

A single unit providing complete independent living facilities for one or more persons, including permanent provisions for living, sleeping, eating, cooking and sanitation.

**DWV**

Abbreviated term for drain, waste and vent piping as used in common plumbing practice.

**Effective Opening**

The minimum cross-sectional area at the point of water-supply discharge, measured or expressed in terms of diameter of a circle and if the opening is not circular, the diameter of a circle of equivalent cross-sectional area. (This is applicable to air gap.)

**Elbow**

A pressure pipe fitting designed to provide an exact change in direction of a pipe run. An elbow provides a sharp turn in the flow path (see "*Bend*" and "*Sweep*").

**[RB] Emergency Escape and Rescue Opening**

An operable exterior window, door or other similar device that provides for a means of escape and access for rescue in the event of an emergency. (See also "*Grade floor emergency escape and rescue opening*.")

**[RB] Energy Storage Systems (ESS)**

One or more devices, assembled together, capable of storing energy in order to supply electrical energy at a future time.

**Enforcement Agency****Local Enforcement Agency**

An agency of local government, a local school board, a community college board of trustees, or a university board of trustees in the State University System with jurisdiction to make inspections of buildings and to enforce the codes which establish standards for design, construction, erection, alteration, repair, modification, or demolition of public or private buildings, structures, or facilities.

**State Enforcement Agency**

The agency of state government with authority to make inspections of buildings and to enforce the codes, as required by Chapter 553, *Florida Statutes* which establish standards for design, construction, erection, alteration, repair, modification or demolition of public or private buildings, structures or facilities.

**Engineer**

A Florida-registered engineer.

**[RB] Engineered Wood Rim Board**

A full-depth structural composite lumber, wood structural panel, structural glued laminated timber or prefabricated wood I-joist member designed to transfer horizontal (shear) and vertical (compression) loads, provide attachment for *diaphragm* sheathing, siding and exterior deck ledgers and provide lateral support at the ends of floor or roof joists or rafters.

**Equipment**

Piping, ducts, vents, control devices and other components of systems other than *appliances* that are permanently installed and integrated to provide control of environmental conditions for buildings. This definition shall also include other systems specifically regulated in this code.

**Equivalent Length**

For determining friction losses in a piping system, the effect of a particular fitting equal to the friction loss through a straight piping length of the same nominal diameter.

**[RE] ERI Reference Design**

A version of the rated design that meets the minimum requirements of the 2006 *International Energy Conservation Code*.

**[RB] Escarpment**

With respect to topographic wind effects, a cliff or steep slope generally separating two levels or gently sloping areas.

**Essentially Nontoxic Transfer Fluids**

Fluids having a Gosselin rating of 1, including propylene glycol; mineral oil; polydimethyl oil oxane; hydrochlorofluorocarbon, chlorofluorocarbon and hydrofluorocarbon refrigerants; and FDA-approved boiler water additives for steam boilers.

**Essentially Toxic Transfer Fluids**

Soil, water or graywater and fluids having a Gosselin rating of 2 or more including ethylene glycol, hydrocarbon oils, ammonia refrigerants and hydrazine.

**Evaporative Cooler**

A device used for reducing air temperature by the process of evaporating water into an airstream.

**Excess Air**

Air that passes through the combustion chamber and the *appliance* flue in excess of what is theoretically required for complete combustion.

**Exhaust Hood, Full Opening**

An exhaust hood with an opening not less than the diameter of the connecting vent.

**Existing Installations**

Any plumbing system regulated by this code that was legally installed prior to the effective date of this code, or for which a *permit* to install has been issued.

**[RB] Exterior Insulation and Finish Systems (EIFS)**

EIFS are nonstructural, nonload-bearing *exterior wall* cladding systems that consist of an insulation board attached either adhesively or mechanically, or both, to the substrate; an integrally reinforced base coat; and a textured protective finish coat.

**[RB] Exterior Insulation and Finish Systems (EIFS) With Drainage**

An EIFS that incorporates a means of drainage applied over a water-resistive barrier.

**[RB] Exterior Wall**

An above-*grade* wall that defines the exterior boundaries of a building. Includes between-floor spandrels, peripheral edges of floors, roof and *basement* knee walls, dormer walls, gable end walls, walls enclosing a mansard roof and *basement walls* with an average below-*grade* wall area that is less than 50 percent of the total opaque and nonopaque area of that enclosing side.

**[RB] Exterior Wall Covering**

A material or assembly of materials applied on the exterior side of exterior walls for the purpose of providing a weather-resistive barrier, insulation or for aesthetics, including but not limited to, veneers, siding, exterior insulation and finish systems, architectural trim and embellishments such as cornices, soffits, and fascias.

**[RB] Facing**

The wood structural panel facings that form the two outmost rigid layers of the structural insulated panel.

**Factory-Built Chimney**

A *listed* and *labeled* chimney composed of factory-made components assembled in the field in accordance with the manufacturer's instructions and the conditions of the *listing*.

**Factory-Made Air Duct**

A *listed* and *labeled* duct manufactured in a factory and assembled in the field in accordance with the manufacturer's instructions and conditions of the *listing*.

**[RE] Fenestration**

Products classified as either vertical fenestration or skylights and sloped glazing, installed in such a manner as to preserve the weather-resistant barrier of the wall or roof in which they are installed. Fenestration includes products with glass or other transparent or translucent materials.

**Fenestration, Vertical**

Windows that are fixed or movable, opaque doors, glazed doors, glazed block and combination opaque and glazed doors installed in a wall at less than 15 degrees from vertical.

**Fiber-Cement (Backerboard, Siding, Soffit, Trim and Underlayment) Products**

Manufactured thin section composites of hydraulic cementitious matrices and discrete nonasbestos fibers.

**Fireblocking**

Building materials or materials *approved* for use as fireblocking, installed to resist the free passage of flame to other areas of the building through concealed spaces.

**[RB] Fireplace**

An assembly consisting of a hearth and fire chamber of noncombustible material and provided with a chimney, for use with solid fuels.

**Factory-Built Fireplace**

A *listed* and *labeled* fireplace and chimney system composed of factory-made components, and assembled in the field in accordance with manufacturer's instructions and the conditions of the listing.

**Masonry Fireplace**

A field-constructed fireplace composed of *solid masonry* units, bricks, stones or concrete.

**Fireplace Stove**

A free-standing, chimney-connected solid-fuel-burning heater designed to be operated with the fire chamber doors in either the open or closed position.

**[RB] Fireplace Throat**

The opening between the top of the firebox and the smoke chamber.

**[RB] Fire-Retardant-Treated Wood**

Wood products that, when impregnated with chemicals by a pressure process or other means during manufacture, exhibit reduced surface burning characteristics and resist propagation of fire.

**Other Means During Manufacture**

A process where the wood raw material is treated with a fire-retardant formulation while undergoing creation as a finished product.

**Pressure Process**

A process for treating wood using an initial vacuum followed by the introduction of pressure above atmospheric.

**[RB] Fire Separation Distance**

The distance measured from the building face to one of the following:

1. To the closest interior *lot line*.
2. To the centerline of a street, an alley or public way.
3. To an imaginary line between two buildings on the *lot*; or
4. For zero lot line developments to an imaginary line between two buildings on adjacent lots when the exterior wall of one building is located on a zero lot line where zero lot line developments are permitted by local regulations.

The distance shall be measured at a right angle from the face of the wall.

**Fixture**

See "*Plumbing fixture*."

**Fixture Branch, Drainage**

A drain serving two or more fixtures that discharges into another portion of the drainage system.

**Fixture Branch, Water-Supply**

A water-supply pipe between the fixture supply and a main water-distribution pipe or fixture group main.

**Fixture Drain**

The drain from the trap of a fixture to the junction of that drain with any other drain pipe.

**Fixture Fitting**

**Supply Fitting**

A fitting that controls the volume or directional flow or both of water and that is either attached to or is *accessed* from a fixture or is used with an open or atmospheric discharge.

**Waste Fitting**

A combination of components that conveys the sanitary waste from the outlet of a fixture to the connection of the sanitary drainage system.

**Fixture Group, Main**

The main water-distribution pipe (or secondary branch) serving a plumbing fixture grouping such as a bath, kitchen or laundry area to which two or more individual fixture branch pipes are connected.

**Fixture Supply**

The water-supply pipe connecting a fixture or fixture fitting to a fixture branch.

**Fixture Unit, Drainage (D.F.U.)**

A measure of probable discharge into the drainage system by various types of plumbing fixtures, used to size DWV piping systems. The drainage fixture-unit value for a particular fixture depends on its volume rate of drainage discharge, on the time duration of a single drainage operation and on the average time between successive operations.

**Fixture Unit, Water-Supply (W.S.F.U.)**

A measure of the probable hydraulic demand on the water supply by various types of plumbing fixtures used to size water-piping systems. The water-supply fixture-unit value for a particular fixture depends on its volume rate of supply, on the time duration of a single supply operation and on the average time between successive operations.

**[RB] Flame Spread**

The propagation of flame over a surface.

**[RB] Flame Spread Index**

A comparative measure, expressed as a dimensionless number, derived from visual measurements of the spread of flame versus time for a material tested in accordance with ASTM E84 or UL 723.

**Flexible Air Connector**

A conduit for transferring air between an air duct or plenum and an air terminal unit, an air inlet or an air outlet. Such conduit is limited in its use, length and location.

**[RB] Flight**

A continuous run of rectangular treads or winders or combination thereof from one landing to another.

**Flood-Level Rim**

The edge of the receptor or fixture from which water overflows.

**Floor Drain**

A plumbing fixture for recess in the floor having a floor-level strainer intended for the purpose of the collection and disposal of waste water used in cleaning the floor and for the collection and disposal of accidental spillage to the floor.

**Floor Furnace**

A self-contained furnace suspended from the floor of the space being heated, taking air for combustion from outside such space, and with means for lighting the *appliance* from such space.

**Flow Pressure**

The static pressure reading in the water-supply pipe near the faucet or water outlet while the faucet or water outlet is open and flowing at capacity.

**Flue**

See "*Vent.*"

**Flue, Appliance**

The passages within an *appliance* through which combustion products pass from the combustion chamber to the flue collar.

**Flue Collar**

The portion of a fuel-burning *appliance* designed for the attachment of a draft hood, vent connector or venting system.

**Flue Gases**

Products of combustion plus excess air in *appliance* flues or heat exchangers.

**Flush Valve**

A device located at the bottom of a flush tank that is operated to flush water closets.

**Flushometer Tank**

A device integrated within an air accumulator vessel that is designed to discharge a predetermined quantity of water to fixtures for flushing purposes.

**Flushometer Valve**

A flushometer valve is a device that discharges a predetermined quantity of water to fixtures for flushing purposes and is actuated

by direct water pressure.

**[RB] Foam Backer Board**

Foam plastic used in siding applications where the foam plastic is a component of the siding.

**[RB] Foam Plastic Insulation**

A plastic that is intentionally expanded by the use of a foaming agent to produce a reduced-density plastic containing voids consisting of open or closed cells distributed throughout the plastic for thermal insulating or acoustic purposes and that has a density less than 20 pounds per cubic foot (320 kg/m<sup>3</sup>) unless it is used as interior trim.

**[RB] Foam Plastic Interior Trim**

Exposed foam plastic used as picture molds, chair rails, crown moldings, baseboards, handrails, ceiling beams, door trim and window trim and similar decorative or protective materials used in fixed applications.

**Fossil Fuel**

Coal, kerosene, oil, fuel gases, or other petroleum or hydrocarbon product that emits carbon monoxide as a by-product of combustion.

**[RB] Fuel Cell Power System, Stationary**

A stationary energy generation system that converts the chemical energy of a fuel and oxidant to electric energy (DC or AC electricity) by an electrochemical process.

**Field-Fabricated Fuel Cell Power System**

A stationary fuel cell power system that is assembled at the job site and is not a preengineered or prepackaged factory-assembled fuel cell power system.

**Preengineered Fuel Cell Power System**

A stationary fuel cell power system consisting of components and modules that are produced in a factory, and shipped to the job site for assembly.

**Prepackaged Fuel Cell Power System**

A stationary fuel cell power system that is factory assembled as a single, complete unit and shipped as a complete unit for installation at the job site.

**Fuel-Piping System**

All piping, tubing, valves and fittings used to connect fuel utilization *equipment* to the point of fuel delivery.

**Full-Open Valve**

A water control or shutoff component in the water supply system piping that, where adjusted for maximum flow, the flow path through the component's closure member is not a restriction in the component's through-flow area.

**Fullway Valve**

A valve that in the full open position has an opening cross-sectional area that is not less than 85 percent of the cross-sectional area of the connecting pipe.

**Furnace**

A vented heating *appliance* designed or arranged to discharge heated air into a *conditioned space* or through a duct or ducts.

**Garage Door Manufacturer**

The party responsible for the completed assembly of the garage door components.

**Glass Mat Gypsum Panel**

A gypsum panel consisting of a noncombustible core primarily of gypsum, surfaced with glass mat partially or completely embedded in the core.

**[RB] Glazing Area**

The interior surface area of all glazed fenestration, including the area of sash, curbing or other framing elements, that enclose *conditioned space*. Includes the area of glazed fenestration assemblies in walls bounding conditioned *basements*.

**[RB] Grade**

The finished ground level adjoining the building at all *exterior walls*.

**[RB] Grade Floor Emergency Escape and Rescue Opening**

An emergency escape and rescue opening located such that the bottom of the clear opening is not more than 44 inches (1118 mm) above or below the finished ground level adjacent to the opening. (See also "*Emergency escape and rescue opening*.")

**Grade, Piping**

See "*Slope*."

**[RB] Grade Plane**

A reference plane representing the average of the finished ground level adjoining the building at all *exterior walls*. Where the finished ground level slopes away from the *exterior walls*, the reference plane shall be established by the lowest points within the area between the building and the *lot line* or, where the *lot line* is more than 6 feet (1829 mm) from the building between the structure and a point 6 feet (1829 mm) from the building.

**Graywater**

As defined by Sections 381.0065(2)(b) and (d) *Florida Statutes*, "Graywater" means that part of domestic sewage that is not blackwater, including waste from the bath, lavatory, laundry, and sink, except kitchen sink waste. "Blackwater" means that part of domestic sewage carried off by toilets, urinals, and kitchen drains.

**Gridded Water Distribution System**

A water distribution system where every water distribution pipe is interconnected so as to provide two or more paths to each fixture supply pipe.

**[RB] Gross Area of Exterior Walls**

The normal projection of all *exterior walls*, including the area of all windows and doors installed therein.

**Ground-Source Heat Pump Loop System**

Piping buried in horizontal or vertical excavations or placed in a body of water for the purpose of transporting heat transfer liquid to and from a heat pump. Included in this definition are closed loop systems in which the liquid is recirculated and open loop systems in which the liquid is drawn from a well or other source.

**[RB] Guard**

A building component or a system of building components located near the open sides of elevated walking surfaces that minimizes the possibility of a fall from the walking surface to the lower level.

**[RB] Guestroom**

Any room or rooms used or intended to be used by one or more guests for living or sleeping purposes.

**[RB] Gypsum Board**

The generic name for a family of sheet products consisting of a noncombustible core primarily of gypsum with paper surfacing. Gypsum wallboard, gypsum sheathing, gypsum base for gypsum *veneer* plaster, exterior gypsum soffit board, predecorated gypsum board and water-resistant gypsum backing board complying with the standards listed in Section R702.3 and Part IX of this code are types of gypsum board.

**[RB] Gypsum Panel Product**

The general name for a family of sheet products consisting essentially of gypsum.

**Gypsum Sheathing**



Gypsum panel products specifically manufactured with enhanced water resistance for use as a substrate for exterior surface materials.

**Gypsum Wallboard**

A gypsum board used primarily as an interior surfacing for building structures.

**[RB] Habitable Space**

A space in a building for living, sleeping, eating or cooking. Bathrooms, toilet rooms, closets, halls, screen enclosures, sunroom categories as defined at Section R301.2.1.1.1, storage or utility spaces and similar areas are not considered *habitable spaces*.

**[RB] Handrail**

A horizontal or sloping rail intended for grasping by the hand for guidance or support.

**Hangers**

See "*Supports*."

**Hazardous Location**

Any location considered to be a fire hazard for flammable vapors, dust, combustible fibers or other highly combustible substances.

**Heat Pump**

An *appliance* having heating or heating and cooling capability and that uses refrigerants to extract heat from air, liquid or other sources.

**[RE] Heating Degree Days (HDD)**

The sum, on an annual basis, of the difference between 65°F (18°C) and the mean temperature for each day as determined from "NOAA Annual Degree Days to Selected Bases Derived from the 1960—1990 Normals" or other weather data sources acceptable to the code official.

**[RB] Height, Building**

The vertical distance from *grade plane* to the average height of the highest roof surface.

**[RB] Height, Story**

The vertical distance from top to top of two successive tiers of beams or finished floor surfaces; and, for the topmost *story*, from the top of the floor finish to the top of the ceiling joists or, where there is not a ceiling, to the top of the roof rafters.

**[RE] High-Efficacy Lamps**

See Section R202 of the *Florida Building Code, Energy Conservation*.

**High-Temperature (H.T.) Chimney**

A high temperature chimney complying with the requirements of UL 103. A Type H.T. chimney is identifiable by the markings "Type H.T." on each chimney pipe section.

**High-Velocity Hurricane Zone (HVHZ)**

This zone consists of Broward and Miami-Dade counties.

**[RB] Hill**

With respect to topographic wind effects, a land surface characterized by strong relief in any horizontal direction.

**[RB] Historic Building**

Buildings that are listed in or eligible for listing in the National Register of Historic Places, or designated as historic under an appropriate state or local law.

**Horizontal Branch, Drainage**

A drain pipe extending laterally from a soil or waste stack or *building drain*, that receives the discharge from one or more *fixture*

*drains.*

**Horizontal Pipe**

Any pipe or fitting that makes an angle of less than 45 degrees (0.79 rad) with the horizontal.

**[MP] Hot Water**

Water at a temperature greater than 120°F (49°C).

**[RB] Hurricane-Prone Regions**

Areas vulnerable to hurricanes, defined as the U.S. Atlantic Ocean and Gulf of Mexico coasts where the ultimate design wind speed,  $V_{ult}$ , is greater than 115 miles per hour (51 m/s), and Hawaii, Puerto Rico, Guam, Virgin Islands and America Samoa.

**Hydrogen-Generating Appliance**

A self-contained package or factory-matched packages of integrated systems for generating gaseous hydrogen. Hydrogen-generating *appliances* utilize electrolysis, reformation, chemical or other processes to generate hydrogen.

**Ignition Source**

A flame, spark or hot surface capable of igniting flammable vapors or fumes. Such sources include *appliance* burners, burner ignitions and electrical switching devices.

**Indirect System**

A solar thermal system in which the gas or liquid in the solar collector loop circulates between the solar collector and a heat exchanger and such gas or liquid is not drained from the system or supplied to the load during normal operation.

**Indirect Waste Pipe**

A waste pipe that discharges into the drainage system through an *air gap* into a trap, fixture or receptor.

**Individual Sewage Disposal System**

A system for disposal of sewage by means of a septic tank or mechanical treatment, designed for use apart from a public sewer to serve a single establishment or building.

**Individual Vent**

A pipe installed to vent a single *fixture drain* that connects with the vent system above or terminates independently outside the building.

**Individual Water Supply**

A supply other than an approved public water supply that serves one or more families.

**[RB] Insulated Siding**

A type of continuous insulation, with manufacturer-installed insulating material as an integral part of the cladding product, having a minimum *R*-value of R-2.

**[RB] Insulated Vinyl Siding**

A vinyl cladding product, with manufacturer-installed foam plastic insulating material as an integral part of the cladding product, having a thermal resistance of not less than R-2.

**[RB] Insulating Concrete Form (ICF)**

A concrete forming system using stay-in-place forms of rigid foam plastic insulation, a hybrid of cement and foam insulation, a hybrid of cement and wood chips, or other insulating material for constructing cast-in-place concrete walls.

**[RB] Insulating Sheathing**

A rigid panel or board insulation material having a thermal resistance of not less than R-2 of the core material with properties suitable for use on walls, floors, roofs, or foundations.

See also Section R202 of the *Florida Building Code, Energy Conservation*.

**[RB] Jurisdiction**

The governmental unit that has adopted this code under due legislative authority.

**[RB] Kitchen**

Kitchen shall mean an area used, or designated to be used, for the preparation of food.

**[RB] Label**

An identification applied on a product by the manufacturer that contains the name of the manufacturer, the function and performance characteristics of the product or material, and the name and identification of an *approved agency* and that indicates that the representative sample of the product or material has been tested and evaluated by an *approved agency*. (See also "*Manufacturer's designation*" and "*Mark*.")

**[RB] Labeled**

*Equipment*, materials or products to which have been affixed a *label*, seal, symbol or other identifying *mark* of a nationally recognized testing laboratory, approved agency or other organization concerned with product evaluation that maintains periodic inspection of the production of the above *labeled* items and whose labeling indicates either that the *equipment*, material or product meets identified standards or has been tested and found suitable for a specified purpose.

**Landscape Architect**

A Florida registered Landscape Architect.

**[RB] Light-Frame Construction**

Construction whose vertical and horizontal structural elements are primarily a system of repetitive wood or cold-formed steel framing members.

**[RB] Listed**

*Equipment*, materials, products or services included in a list published by an organization acceptable to the code official and concerned with evaluation of products or services that maintains periodic inspection of production of *listed equipment* or materials or periodic evaluation of services and whose listing states either that the *equipment*, material, product or service meets identified standards or has been tested and found suitable for a specified purpose.

**[RB] Live Loads**

Those loads produced by the use and occupancy of the building or other structure and do not include construction or environmental loads such as wind load, rain load, flood load or dead load.

**Living Space**

Space within a *dwelling unit* utilized for living, sleeping, eating, cooking, bathing, washing and sanitation purposes.

**Local Exhaust**

An exhaust system that uses one or more fans to exhaust air from a specific room or rooms within a dwelling.

**Local Floodplain Management Ordinance**

An ordinance or regulation adopted pursuant to the authority granted to local governments by Title 44 Code of Federal Regulations, Sections 59 and 60 for participation in the National Flood Insurance Program.

**[RB] Lodging House**

A one-family dwelling where one or more occupants are primarily permanent in nature, and rent is paid for guestrooms.

**[RB] Lot**

A measured portion or parcel of land considered as a unit having fixed boundaries.

**[RB] Lot Line**

The line that bounds a plot of ground described as a *lot* in the title to the property.

### **Macerating Toilet Systems**

A system comprised of a sump with macerating pump and with connections for a water closet and other plumbing fixtures, that is designed to accept, grind and pump wastes to an *approved* point of discharge.

### **Main**

The principal pipe artery to which branches may be connected.

### **Main Sewer**

See "*Public sewer*."

### **Manifold Water Distribution Systems**

A fabricated piping arrangement in which a large supply main is fitted with multiple branches in close proximity in which water is distributed separately to fixtures from each branch.

### **[RB] Manufactured Home**

*Manufactured home* means a structure, transportable in one or more sections, that in the traveling mode is 8 body feet (2438 body mm) or more in width or 40 body feet (12 192 body mm) or more in length, or, where erected on site, is 320 square feet (30 m<sup>2</sup>) or more, and that is built on a permanent chassis and designed to be used as a *dwelling* with or without a permanent foundation where connected to the required utilities, and includes the plumbing, heating, air-conditioning and electrical systems contained therein; except that such term shall include any structure that meets all the requirements of this paragraph except the size requirements and with respect to which the manufacturer voluntarily files a certification required by the secretary (HUD) and complies with the standards established under this title. For mobile homes built prior to June 15, 1976, a *label* certifying compliance to the Standard for Mobile Homes, NFPA 501, in effect at the time of manufacture is required. For the purpose of these provisions, a mobile home shall be considered to be a *manufactured home*.

### **[RB] Manufacturer's Designation**

An identification applied on a product by the manufacturer indicating that a product or material complies with a specified standard or set of rules. (See also "*Mark*" and "*Label*.")

### **[RB] Manufacturer's Installation Instructions**

Printed instructions included with *equipment* as part of the conditions of their *listing* and *labeling*.

### **[RB] Mark**

An identification applied on a product by the manufacturer indicating the name of the manufacturer and the function of a product or material. (See also "*Manufacturer's designation*" and "*Label*.")

### **[RB] Masonry Chimney**

A field-constructed chimney composed of solid masonry units, bricks, stones or concrete.

### **[RB] Masonry Heater**

A masonry heater is a solid fuel burning heating *appliance* constructed predominantly of concrete or solid masonry having a mass of not less than 1,100 pounds (500 kg), excluding the chimney and foundation. It is designed to absorb and store a substantial portion of heat from a fire built in the firebox by routing exhaust gases through internal heat exchange channels in which the flow path downstream of the firebox includes not less than one 180-degree (3.14-rad) change in flow direction before entering the chimney and that deliver heat by radiation through the masonry surface of the heater.

### **[RB] Masonry, Solid**

Masonry consisting of solid masonry units laid contiguously with the joints between the units filled with mortar.

### **[RB] Masonry Unit**

Brick, tile, stone, architectural cast stone, glass block or concrete block conforming to the requirements specified in Section 2103 of the *Florida Building Code, Building*.

**Clay**

A building unit larger in size than a brick, composed of burned clay, shale, fire clay or mixtures thereof.

**Concrete**

A building unit or block larger in size than 12 inches by 4 inches by 4 inches (305 mm by 102 mm by 102 mm) made of cement and suitable aggregates.

**Glass**

Nonload-bearing masonry composed of glass units bonded by mortar.

**Hollow**

A masonry unit with a net cross-sectional area in any plane parallel to the loadbearing surface that is less than 75 percent of its gross cross-sectional area measured in the same plane.

**Solid**

A masonry unit with a net cross-sectional area in every plane parallel to the loadbearing surface that is 75 percent or more of its cross-sectional area measured in the same plane.

**[RE] Mass Wall**

Masonry or concrete walls having a mass greater than or equal to 30 pounds per square foot ( $146 \text{ kg/m}^2$ ), solid wood walls having a mass greater than or equal to 20 pounds per square foot ( $98 \text{ kg/m}^2$ ), and any other walls having a heat capacity greater than or equal to  $6 \text{ Btu/ft}^2 \cdot ^\circ\text{F}$  [ $123 \text{ J/(m}^2 \cdot \text{K)}$ ].

**Material Code Violation**

A material code violation is a violation that exists within a completed building, structure or facility which may reasonably result, or has resulted, in physical harm to a person or significant damage to the performance of a building or its systems.

**Material Violation**

As defined in *Florida Statutes*.

**[RB] Mean Roof Height**

The average of the roof eave height and the height to the highest point on the roof surface, except that eave height shall be used for roof angle of less than or equal to 10 degrees ( $0.18 \text{ rad}$ ).

**Means of Escape**

A way out of a building or structure that does not conform to the strict definition of means of egress but does provide an alternate way out. A means of escape consists of a door, stairway, passage or hall providing a way of unobstructed travel to the outside at street or ground level. It may also consist of a passage through an adjacent nonlockable space, independent of and remotely located from the means of egress, to any approved exit.

**Mechanical Draft System**

A venting system designed to remove flue or vent gases by mechanical means, that consists of an induced draft portion under nonpositive static pressure or a forced draft portion under positive static pressure.

**Forced Draft Venting System**

A portion of a venting system using a fan or other mechanical means to cause the removal of flue or vent gases under positive static pressure.

**Induced Draft Venting System**

A portion of a venting system using a fan or other mechanical means to cause the removal of flue or vent gases under nonpositive static vent pressure.

**Power Venting System**

A portion of a venting system using a fan or other mechanical means to cause the removal of flue or vent gases under positive

static vent pressure.

**Mechanical Exhaust System**

A system for removing air from a room or space by mechanical means.

**Mechanical Joint**

1. A connection between pipes, fittings or pipes and fittings that is not welded, brazed, caulked, soldered, solvent cemented or heat-fused.
2. A general form of gas- or liquid-tight connections obtained by the joining of parts through a positive holding mechanical construction such as, but not limited to, flanged, screwed, clamped or flared connections.

**Mechanical System**

A system specifically addressed and regulated in this code and composed of components, devices, *appliances* and *equipment*.

**[RB] Metal Roof Panel**

An interlocking metal sheet having a minimum installed weather exposure of 3 square feet (0.279 m<sup>2</sup>) per sheet.

**Metal Roof Panel, or Metal Roof Shingle, Manufacturer**

The party responsible for forming sheet metal raw materials into the metal roof panels and/or metal roof shingles used in building construction.

**[RB] Metal Roof Shingle**

An interlocking metal sheet having an installed weather exposure less than 3 square feet (0.279 m<sup>2</sup>) per sheet.

**[RB] Mezzanine**

An intermediate level or levels between the floor and ceiling of any *story*.

**[RB] Modified Bitumen Roof Covering**

One or more layers of polymer modified asphalt sheets. The sheet materials shall be fully adhered or mechanically attached to the substrate or held in place with an *approved* ballast layer.

**Modular Home**

Any residential unit, constructed to standards promulgated by the Florida Building Commission, away from the installation site, and which bears a Department of Business and Professional Regulation Insignia.

**[RB] Multiple-Station Smoke Alarm**

Two or more single station alarm devices that are capable of interconnection such that actuation of one causes all integral or separate audible alarms to operate.

**[RB] Nailable Substrate**

A product or material such as framing, sheathing or furring, composed of wood or wood-based materials, or other materials and fasteners providing equivalent fastener withdrawal resistance.

**Natural Draft System**

A venting system designed to remove flue or vent gases under nonpositive static vent pressure entirely by natural draft.

**[RB] Naturally Durable Wood**

The heartwood of the following species with the exception that an occasional piece with corner sapwood is permitted if 90 percent or more of the width of each side on which it occurs is heartwood.

**Decay Resistant**

Redwood, cedar, black locust and black walnut.

**Termite Resistant**

Alaska yellow cedar, redwood, Eastern red cedar and Western red cedar including all sapwood of Western red cedar.

**[RB] Noncombustible Material**

A material that passes ASTM E136.

**[RB] Nosing**

The leading edge of treads of stairs and of landings at the top of stairway flights.

**[RB] Occupied Space**

The total area of all buildings or structures on any *lot* or parcel of ground projected on a horizontal plane, excluding permitted projections as allowed by this code.

**Offset**

A combination of fittings that makes two changes in direction, bringing one section of the pipe out of line and into a line parallel with the other section.

**On-Site Nonpotable Water Reuse Systems**

Water systems for the collection, treatment, storage, distribution, and reuse of nonpotable water generated on site, including but not limited to graywater systems. This definition does not include rainwater harvesting systems.

**[RB] Owner**

Any person, agent, firm or corporation having a legal or equitable interest in the property.

**[RB] Pan Flashing**

Corrosion-resistant flashing at the base of an opening that is integrated into the building exterior wall to direct water to the exterior and is premanufactured, fabricated, formed or applied at the job site.

**[RB] Panel Thickness**

Thickness of core plus two layers of structural wood panel facings.

**Pellet Fuel-Burning Appliance**

A closed combustion, vented *appliance* equipped with a fuel feed mechanism for burning processed pellets of solid fuel of a specified size and composition.

**Pellet Vent**

A vent *listed* and *labeled* for use with a *listed* pellet fuel-burning *appliance*.

**[RB] Performance Category**

A designation of wood structural panels as related to the panel performance used in Chapters 4, 5, 6 and 8.

**[RB] Permit**

An official document or certificate issued by the authority having jurisdiction that authorizes performance of a specified activity.

**[RB] Person**

An individual, heirs, executors, administrators or assigns, and a firm, partnership or corporation, its or their successors or assigns, or the agent of any of the aforesaid.

**[RB] Photovoltaic Module**

A complete, environmentally protected unit consisting of solar cells, optics and other components, exclusive of a tracker, designed to generate DC power where exposed to sunlight.

**[RB] Photovoltaic Panel**

A collection of photovoltaic modules mechanically fastened together, wired, and designed to provide a field-installable unit.

**[RB] Photovoltaic Panel System**

A system that incorporates discrete photovoltaic panels that convert solar radiation into electricity, including rack support systems.

**[RB] Photovoltaic Shingles**

A *roof covering* that resembles shingles and that incorporates photovoltaic modules.

**Pitch**

See "*Slope*."

**[RB] Plastic Composite**

A generic designation that refers to wood-plastic composites and plastic lumber.

**[RB] Platform Construction**

A method of construction by which floor framing bears on load bearing walls that are not continuous through the *story* levels or floor framing.

**Plenum**

A chamber that forms part of an air-circulation system other than the *occupied space* being conditioned.

**Plumbing**

For the purpose of this code, plumbing refers to those installations, repairs, maintenance and *alterations* regulated by Chapters 25 through 33.

**Plumbing Appliance**

An energized household *appliance* with plumbing connections, such as a dishwasher, food waste disposer, clothes washer or water heater.

**Plumbing Appurtenance**

A device or assembly that is an adjunct to the basic plumbing system and does not demand additional water supply or add any discharge load to the system. It is presumed that it performs some useful function in the operation, maintenance, servicing, economy or safety of the plumbing system. Examples include filters, relief valves and aerators.

**Plumbing Fixture**

A receptacle or device that is connected to a water supply system or discharges to a drainage system or both. Such receptacles or devices require a supply of water; or discharge liquid waste or liquid-borne solid waste; or require a supply of water and discharge waste to a drainage system.

**Plumbing Systems**

Includes the water distribution pipes; plumbing fixtures and traps; water-treating or water-using *equipment*; soil, waste and vent pipes; and building drains; in addition to their respective connections, devices and appurtenances within a structure or premises; and the water service, building sewer and building storm sewer serving such structure or premises.

**Pollution**

A low-hazard or non-health hazard impairment of the quality of the potable water to a degree that does not create a hazard to the public health and that does adversely and unreasonably affect the aesthetic qualities of such potable water for domestic use.

**[RB] Polypropylene Siding**

A shaped material, made principally from polypropylene homopolymer, or copolymer, that in some cases contains fillers or reinforcements, that is used to clad *exterior walls* or buildings.

**Portable-Fuel-Cell Appliance**



A fuel cell generator of electricity that is not fixed in place. A portable-fuel-cell *appliance* utilizes a cord and plug connection to a grid-isolated load and has an integral fuel supply.

**[RB] Positive Roof Drainage**

The drainage condition in which consideration has been made for the loading deflections of the roof deck, and sufficient slope has been provided to ensure drainage of the roof within 48 hours of precipitation.

**Potable Water**

Water free from impurities present in amounts sufficient to cause disease or harmful physiological effects and conforming in bacteriological and chemical quality to the requirements of the public health authority having jurisdiction.

**[RB] Precast Concrete**

A structural concrete element cast elsewhere than its final position in the structure.

**[RB] Precast Concrete Foundation Walls**

Pre-engineered, precast concrete wall panels that are designed to withstand specified stresses and used to build below-grade foundations.

**Press-Connect Joint**

A permanent mechanical joint incorporating an elastomeric seal or an elastomeric seal and corrosion-resistant grip or bite ring. The joint is made with a pressing tool and jaw or ring approved by the fitting manufacturer.

**Pressure-Relief Valve**

A pressure-actuated valve held closed by a spring or other means and designed to automatically relieve pressure at the pressure at which it is set.

**Professional Surveyor and Mapper**

An individual who is licensed or registered to engage in the practice of surveying and mapping under Chapter 472, *Florida Statutes*.

**Public Sewer**

A common sewer directly controlled by public authority.

**Public Water Main**

A water-supply pipe for public use controlled by public authority.

**[RB] Public Way**

Any street, alley or other parcel of land open to the outside air leading to a public street, that has been deeded, dedicated or otherwise permanently appropriated to the public for public use and that has a clear width and height of not less than 10 feet (3048 mm).

**Purge**

To clear of air, gas or other foreign substances.

**Push-Fit Fitting**

A mechanical fitting that joins pipes or tubes and achieves a seal by mating the pipe or tube into the fitting.

**Quick-Closing Valve**

A valve or faucet that closes automatically where released manually or controlled by mechanical means for fast-action closing.

**[RE] R-Value, Thermal Resistance**

The inverse of the time rate of heat flow through a *building thermal envelope* element from one of its bounding surfaces to the other for a unit temperature difference between the two surfaces, under steady state conditions, per unit area ( $h \cdot ft^2 \cdot ^\circ F/Btu$ ).

**[RB] Ramp**

A walking surface that has a running slope steeper than 1 unit vertical in 20 units horizontal (5-percent slope).

**[RE] Rated Design**

A description of the proposed *building*, used to determine the energy rating index.

**Ready Access (To)**

That which enables a device, appliance or equipment to be directly reached, without requiring the removal or movement of any panel, door or similar obstruction.

**Receptor**

A fixture or device that receives the discharge from indirect waste pipes.

**Reclaimed Water**

Nonpotable water that has been derived from the treatment of waste water by a facility or system licensed or permitted to produce water meeting the *jurisdiction's* water requirements for its intended uses. Also known as "Recycled Water."

**[RE] Reflective Duct Insulation**

A thermal insulation assembly consisting of one or more surfaces that have an emittance of 0.1 or less, and that bound an enclosed air space or spaces.

**Refrigerant**

A substance used to produce refrigeration by its expansion or evaporation.

**Refrigerant Compressor**

A specific machine, with or without accessories, for compressing a given refrigerant vapor.

**Refrigerating System**

A combination of interconnected parts forming a closed circuit in which refrigerant is circulated for the purpose of extracting, then rejecting, heat. A direct refrigerating system is one in which the evaporator or condenser of the refrigerating system is in direct contact with the air or other substances to be cooled or heated. An indirect refrigerating system is one in which a secondary coolant cooled or heated by the refrigerating system is circulated to the air or other substance to be cooled or heated.

**[RB] Registered Design Professional**

An individual who is registered or licensed to practice their respective design profession as defined by the statutory requirements of the professional registration laws of the state or *jurisdiction* in which the project is to be constructed. This includes any registered design professional so long as they are practicing within the scope of their license, which includes those licensed under Chapters 471 and 481, *Florida Statutes*.

**Registered Termiticide**

Product listed as registered for use as a preventative treatment for termites for new construction by the Florida Department of Agriculture and Consumer Services under authority of Chapter 487, *Florida Statutes*.

**Relief Valve, Vacuum**

A device to prevent excessive buildup of vacuum in a pressure vessel.

**[RB] Repair**

The reconstruction or renewal of any part of an existing building for the purpose of its maintenance or to correct damage.

See also Section R202 of the *Florida Building Code, Energy Conservation*.

**[RB] Reroofing**

The process of recovering or replacing an existing roof covering. See "*Roof recover*."

See also Section R202 of the *Florida Building Code, Energy Conservation*.

**Return Air**

Air removed from an *approved conditioned space* or location and recirculated or exhausted.

**[RB] Ridge**

With respect to topographic wind effects, an elongated crest of a hill characterized by strong relief in two directions.

**[RB] Riser**

1. The vertical component of a step or stair.
2. A water pipe that extends vertically one full *story* or more to convey water to branches or to a group of fixtures.

**[RB] Roof Assembly**

A system designed to provide weather protection and resistance to design loads. The system consists of a roof covering and roof deck or a single component serving as both the roof covering and the roof deck. A roof assembly includes the roof covering, roof deck and may include a *vapor retarder*, thermal barrier, insulation or similar substrate.

**[RB] Roof Covering**

The covering applied to the roof deck for weather resistance, fire classification or appearance.

**[RB] Roof Deck**

The flat or sloped surface not including its supporting members or vertical supports.

**[RB] Roof Recover**

The process of installing an additional roof covering over a prepared existing roof covering without removing the existing roof covering.

See also Section R202 of the *Florida Building Code, Energy Conservation*.

**[RB] Roof Repair**

Reconstruction or renewal of any part of an existing roof for the purposes of its maintenance.

See also Section R202 of the *Florida Building Code, Energy Conservation*.

**[RB] Roof Replacement**

The process of removing the existing *roof covering*, repairing any damaged substrate and installing a new *roof covering*.

**Roof Section**

A separation or division of a roof area by existing expansion joints, parapet walls, flashing (excluding valley), difference of elevation (excluding hips and ridges), roof type or legal description; not including the roof area required for a proper tie-off with an existing system.

**Roof System**

A roof system consists of a *roof covering* and other interacting roofing components and may include *vapor retarder*, a thermal barrier, insulation or other similar substrate. The system does not include the roof deck unless it is part of a single component serving as the roof covering and the *roof deck*.

**[RB] Rooftop Structure**

An enclosed structure on or above the roof of any part of a building.

**Room Heater**

A freestanding heating *appliance* installed in the space being heated and not connected to ducts.

**Rough-In**

The installation of the parts of the plumbing system that must be completed prior to the installation of fixtures. This includes DWV, water supply and built-in fixture supports.

**[RB] Running Bond**

The placement of masonry units such that head joints in successive courses are horizontally offset not less than one-quarter the unit length.

**Sanitary Sewer**

A sewer that carries sewage and excludes storm, surface and groundwater.

**Screen Enclosure**

A building or part thereof, in whole or in part self-supporting, and having walls of insect screening with or without removable vinyl or acrylic wind break panels and a roof of insect screening, plastic, aluminum or similar lightweight material, or other materials and assemblies such as a patio, a deck, or the roof of a structure.

**Scupper**

An opening in a wall or parapet that allows water to drain from a roof.

**Separate Atmosphere**

The atmosphere that exists between rooms, spaces or areas that are separated by an approved smoke barrier.

**Septic Tank**

A water-tight receptor that receives the discharge of a building sanitary drainage system and is constructed so as to separate solids from the liquid, digest organic matter through a period of detention, and allow the liquids to discharge into the soil outside of the tank through a system of open joint or perforated piping or a seepage pit.

**Sewage**

Any liquid waste containing animal matter, vegetable matter or other impurity in suspension or solution.

**Sewage Pump**

A permanently installed mechanical device for removing sewage or liquid waste from a sump.

**[RB] Shall**

The term, where used in the code, is construed as mandatory.

**[RB] Shear Wall**

A general term for walls that are designed and constructed to resist racking from lateral loads by use of masonry, concrete, cold-formed steel or wood framing in accordance with Chapter 6 of this code and the associated limitations in Section R301.2 of this code.

**[RB] Single-Ply Membrane**

A roofing membrane that is field applied using one layer of membrane material (either homogeneous or composite) rather than multiple layers.

**[RB] Single-Station Smoke Alarm**

An assembly incorporating the detector, control *equipment* and alarm sounding device in one unit that is operated from a power supply either in the unit or obtained at the point of installation.

**Site-Built Single-Family Residential Structures**

This term shall mean site-built single-family detached residential structures.

**[RB] Shingle Fashion**

A method of installing roof or wall coverings, water-resistive barriers, flashing or other building components such that upper layers of material are placed overlapping lower layers of material to provide drainage and protect against water intrusion at unsealed

penetrations and joints or in combination with sealed joints.

**[RE] Skylight**

See also Section R202 of the *Florida Building Code, Energy Conservation*.

**[RB] Skylights and Sloped Glazing**

Glass or other transparent or translucent glazing material installed at a slope of 15 degrees (0.26 rad) or more from vertical. Glazing materials in skylights, including unit skylights, tubular daylighting devices, solariums, sunrooms, roofs and sloped walls are included in this definition.

**[RB] Skylight, Unit**

A factory assembled, glazed fenestration unit, containing one panel of glazing material, that allows for natural daylighting through an opening in the roof assembly while preserving the weather-resistant barrier of the roof.

**Slip Joint**

A mechanical-type joint used primarily on fixture traps. The joint tightness is obtained by compressing a friction-type washer such as rubber, nylon, neoprene, lead or special packing material against the pipe by the tightening of a (slip) nut.

**Slope**

The fall (pitch) of a line of pipe in reference to a horizontal plane. In drainage, the slope is expressed as the fall in units vertical per units horizontal (percent) for a length of pipe.

**[RB] Smoke-Developed Index**

A comparative measure, expressed as a dimensionless number, derived from measurements of smoke obscuration versus time for a material tested in accordance with ASTM E84 or UL 723.

**Soil Stack or Pipe**

A pipe that conveys sewage containing fecal material.

**[RE] Solar Heat Gain Coefficient (SHGC)**

The solar heat gain through a fenestration or glazing assembly relative to the incident solar radiation (Btu/h • ft<sup>2</sup> • °F).

**[RB] Solid Masonry**

Load-bearing or nonload-bearing construction using masonry units where the net cross-sectional area of each unit in any plane parallel to the bearing surface is not less than 75 percent of its gross cross-sectional area. Solid masonry units shall conform to ASTM C55, C62, C73, C145 or C216.

**[RB] Spline**

A strip of wood structural panel cut from the same material used for the panel facings, used to connect two structural insulated panels. The strip (spline) fits into a groove cut into the vertical edges of the two structural insulated panels to be joined. Splines are used behind each facing of the structural insulated panels being connected as shown in Figure R610.8.

**Stack**

Any main vertical DWV line, including offsets, that extends one or more stories as directly as possible to its vent terminal.

**[RB] Stack Bond**

The placement of masonry units in a bond pattern is such that head joints in successive courses are vertically aligned. For the purpose of this code, requirements for stack bond shall apply to all masonry laid in other than running bond.

**Stack Vent**

The extension of soil or waste stack above the highest horizontal drain connected.

**[RB] Stair**

A change in elevation, consisting of one or more risers.

**[RB] Stairway**

One or more flights of stairs, either interior or exterior, with the necessary landings and connecting platforms to form a continuous and uninterrupted passage from one level to another.

**[RB] Stairway, Spiral**

A stairway with a plan view of closed circular form and uniform section-shaped treads radiating from a minimum-diameter circle.

**[RB] Standard Truss**

Any construction that does not permit the roof-ceiling insulation to achieve the required *R*-value over the *exterior walls*.

**Stationary Fuel Cell Power Plant**

A self-contained package or factory-matched packages that constitute an automatically-operated assembly of integrated systems for generating useful electrical energy and recoverable thermal energy that is permanently connected and fixed in place.

**Storm Sewer, Drain**

A pipe used for conveying rainwater, surface water, subsurface water and similar liquid waste.

**[RB] Story**

That portion of a building included between the upper surface of a floor and the upper surface of the floor or roof next above.

**[RB] Story Above Grade Plane**

Any *story* having its finished floor surface entirely above *grade plane*, or in which the finished surface of the floor next above is either of the following:

1. More than 6 feet (1829 mm) *above grade plane*.
2. More than 12 feet (3658 mm) above the finished ground level at any point.

**[RB] Structural Composite Lumber**

Structural members manufactured using wood elements bonded together with exterior adhesives.

Examples of structural composite lumber are:

**Laminated Strand Lumber (LSL)**

A composite of wood strand elements with wood fibers primarily oriented along the length of the member, where the least dimension of the wood strand elements is 0.10 inch (2.54 mm) or less and their average lengths are not less than 150 times the least dimension of the wood strand elements.

**Laminated Veneer Lumber (LVL)**

A composite of wood veneer elements with wood fibers primarily oriented along the length of the member, where the veneer element thicknesses are 0.25 inches (6.4 mm) or less.

**Oriented Strand Lumber (OSL)**

A composite of wood strand elements with wood fibers primarily oriented along the length of the member, where the least dimension of the wood strand elements is 0.10 inch (2.54 mm) or less and their average lengths are not less than 75 times and less than 150 times the least dimension of the wood strand elements.

**Parallel Strand Lumber (PSL)**

A composite of wood strand elements with wood fibers primarily oriented along the length of the member, where the least dimension of the wood strand elements is 0.25 inch (6.4 mm) or less and their average lengths are not less than 300 times the least dimension of the wood strand elements.

**[RB] Structural Insulated Panel (SIP)**

A structural sandwich panel that consists of a light-weight foam plastic core securely laminated between two thin, rigid wood

structural panel facings.

**[RB] Structure**

That which is built or constructed.

**[RB] Subsoil Drain**

A drain that collects subsurface water or seepage water and conveys such water to a place of disposal.

**Sump**

A tank or pit that receives sewage or waste, located below the normal *grade* of the gravity system and that must be emptied by mechanical means.

**Sump Pump**

A pump installed to empty a sump. These pumps are used for removing storm water only. The pump is selected for the specific head and volume of the load and is usually operated by level controllers.

**Sun Control Structure**

An accessory structure consisting of columns or posts supporting an open roof of girders, beams, or cross rafters with or without fixed or operational louvers serving to direct sunlight.

**[RB] Sunroom**

1. A one-story structure attached to a dwelling with a glazing area in excess of 40 percent of the gross area of the structure's exterior walls and roof.
2. A one-story structure added to a dwelling with solid roof panels without sloped glazing. The sunroom walls may have any configuration, provided the open areas consisting of operable or fixed glass or windows or side hinged or sliding glass doors of the longer wall and one additional wall is equal to at least 65 percent of the area below 6 foot 8 inches (2032 mm) of each wall, measured from the floor. For the purposes of this code the term sunroom as used herein shall include conservatories, sunspaces, solariums, and porch or patio covers or enclosures.

See also Section R202 of the *Florida Building Code, Energy Conservation*.

**Supply Air**

Air delivered to a *conditioned space* through ducts or plenums from the heat exchanger of a heating, cooling or ventilating system.

**Supports**

Devices for supporting, hanging and securing pipes, fixtures and *equipment*.

**Sweep**

A drainage fitting designed to provide a change in direction of a drain pipe of less than the angle specified by the amount necessary to establish the desired slope of the line. Sweeps provide a longer turning radius than bends and a less turbulent flow pattern (see "*Bend*" and "*Elbow*").

**Temperature- And Pressure-Relief (T and P) Valve**

A combination relief valve designed to function as both a temperature-relief and pressure-relief valve.

**Temperature-Relief Valve**

A temperature-actuated valve designed to discharge automatically at the temperature at which it is set.

**[RB] Termite-Resistant Material**

Pressure-preservative treated wood in accordance with the AWPA standards in Section R317.1, naturally durable termite-resistant wood, steel, concrete, masonry or other *approved* material.

**[RE] Thermal Isolation**

Physical and space conditioning separation from *conditioned space(s)* consisting of existing or new walls, doors or windows. The *conditioned space(s)* shall be controlled as separate zones for heating and cooling or conditioned by separate *equipment*.

See also Section R202 of the *Florida Building Code, Energy Conservation*.

**[RE] Thermal Resistance, *R*-Value**

The inverse of the time rate of heat flow through a body from one of its bounding surfaces to the other for a unit temperature difference between the two surfaces, under steady state conditions, per unit area ( $h \cdot \text{ft}^2 \cdot ^\circ\text{F}/\text{Btu}$ ) ( $\text{m}^2 \cdot \text{K}/\text{W}$ ).

**[RE] Thermal Transmittance, *U*-factor**

The coefficient of heat transmission (air to air) through a building envelope component or assembly, equal to the time rate of heat flow per unit area and unit temperature difference between the warm side and cold side air films ( $\text{Btu}/h \cdot \text{ft}^2 \cdot ^\circ\text{F}$ ) ( $\text{W}/(\text{m}^2 \cdot \text{K})$ ).

**[RB] Third-Party Certification Agency**

An approved agency operating a product or material certification system that incorporates initial product testing, assessment and surveillance of a manufacturer's quality control system.

**[RB] Third-Party Certified**

Certification obtained by the manufacturer indicating that the function and performance characteristics of a product or material have been determined by testing and ongoing surveillance by an approved third-party certification agency. Assertion of certification is in the form of identification in accordance with the requirements of the third-party certification agency.

**[RB] Third-Party Tested**

Procedure by which an approved testing laboratory provides documentation that a product material or system conforms to specified requirements.

**[RB] Townhouse**

A single-family *dwelling unit* not exceeding three stories in height constructed in a group of two or more attached units with property lines separating such units in which each unit extends from foundation to roof and with a *yard* or public way on not less than two sides.

**Trap**

A fitting, either separate or built into a fixture, that provides a liquid seal to prevent the emission of sewer gases without materially affecting the flow of sewage or waste water through it.

**Trap Arm**

That portion of a *fixture drain* between a trap weir and the vent fitting.

**Trap Primer**

A device or system of piping to maintain a water seal in a trap, typically installed where infrequent use of the trap would result in evaporation of the trap seal, such as floor drains.

**Trap Seal**

The trap seal is the maximum vertical depth of liquid that a trap will retain, measured between the crown weir and the top of the dip of the trap.

**[RB] Trim**

Picture molds, chair rails, baseboards, handrails, door and window frames, and similar decorative or protective materials used in fixed applications.

**[RB] Truss Design Drawing**

The graphic depiction of an individual truss, that describes the design and physical characteristics of the truss.

**[RE] Tubular Daylighting Device (TDD)**



A nonoperable fenestration unit primarily designed to transmit daylight from a roof surface to an interior ceiling via a tubular conduit. The basic unit consists of an exterior glazed weathering surface, a light-transmitting tube with a reflective interior surface, and an interior-sealing device such as a translucent ceiling panel. The unit may be factory assembled, or field assembled from a manufactured kit.

#### **Type L Vent**

A *listed* and *labeled* vent conforming to UL 641 for venting oil-burning *appliances listed* for use with Type L vents or with gas *appliances listed* for use with Type B vents.

#### **[RE] U-factor (Thermal Transmittance)**

See also Section R202 of the *Florida Building Code, Energy Conservation*.

#### **[RB] Underlayment**

One or more layers of felt, sheathing paper, nonbituminous saturated felt, or other *approved* material over which a roof covering, with a slope of 2 to 12 (17-percent slope) or greater, is applied.

#### **Vacuum Breaker**

A device that prevents back-siphonage of water by admitting atmospheric pressure through ports to the discharge side of the device.

#### **Vapor Diffusion Port**

An assembly constructed or installed within a roof assembly at an opening in the roof deck to convey water vapor from an unvented attic to the outside atmosphere.

#### **Vapor Permeable**

The property of having a moisture vapor permeance rating of 5 perms ( $2.9 \times 10^{-10}$  kg/Pa  $\times$  s  $\times$  m<sup>2</sup>) or greater when tested in accordance with Procedure A or Procedure B of ASTM E96. A vapor permeable material permits the passage of moisture vapor.

#### **[RB] Vapor Retarder Class**

A measure of the ability of a material or assembly to limit the amount of moisture that passes through that material or assembly. Vapor retarder class shall be defined using the desiccant method with Procedure A of ASTM E96 as follows:

Class I: 0.1 perm or less

Class II:  $0.1 < \text{perm} \leq 1.0$  perm

Class III:  $1.0 < \text{perm} \leq 10$  perm

#### **Vent**

A passageway for conveying flue gases from fuel-fired *appliances*, or their vent connectors, to the outside atmosphere.

#### **Vent Collar**

See "*Flue collar*."

#### **Vent Connector**

That portion of a venting system that connects the flue collar or draft hood of an *appliance* to a vent.

#### **Vent Damper Device, Automatic**

A device intended for installation in the venting system, in the outlet of an individual, automatically operated fuel burning *appliance* and that is designed to open the venting system automatically where the *appliance* is in operation and to close off the venting system automatically where the *appliance* is in a standby or shutdown condition.

#### **Vent Gases**

Products of combustion from fuel-burning *appliances*, plus excess air and dilution air, in the venting system above the draft hood or draft regulator.

**Vent Stack**

A vertical vent pipe installed to provide circulation of air to and from the drainage system and that extends through one or more stories.

**Vent System**

Piping installed to equalize pneumatic pressure in a drainage system to prevent trap seal loss or blow-back due to siphonage or back pressure.

**Ventilation**

The natural or mechanical process of supplying conditioned or unconditioned air to, or removing such air from, any space.

See also Section R202 of the *Florida Building Code, Energy Conservation*.

**Venting**

Removal of combustion products to the outdoors.

**Venting System**

A continuous open passageway from the flue collar of an *appliance* to the outside atmosphere for the purpose of removing flue or vent gases. A venting system is usually composed of a vent or a chimney and vent connector, if used, assembled to form the open passageway.

**Vertical Pipe**

Any pipe or fitting that makes an angle of 45 degrees (0.79 rad) or more with the horizontal.

**[RB] Vinyl Siding**

A shaped material, made principally from rigid polyvinyl chloride (PVC), that is used to cover exterior walls of buildings.

**[RB] Wall, Retaining**

A wall not laterally supported at the top, that resists lateral soil load and other imposed loads.

**[RB] Walls**

Walls shall be defined as follows:

**Load-Bearing Wall**

A wall supporting any vertical load in addition to its own weight.

**Nonbearing Wall**

A wall which does not support vertical loads other than its own weight.

**Waste**

Liquid-borne waste that is free of fecal matter.

**Waste Pipe or Stack**

Piping that conveys only liquid sewage not containing fecal material.

**Waste Receptor**

A floor sink, standpipe, hub drain or a floor drain that receives the discharge of one or more indirect waste pipes.

**Water Distribution System**

Piping that conveys water from the service to the plumbing fixtures, *appliances*, appurtenances, *equipment*, devices or other systems served, including fittings and control valves.

**Water Heater**

Any heating *appliance* or *equipment* that heats potable water and supplies such water to the potable hot water distribution system.

**Water Main**

A water supply pipe for public use.

**Water Outlet**

A valved discharge opening, including a hose bibb, through which water is removed from the potable water system supplying water to a plumbing fixture or plumbing *appliance* that requires either an *air gap* or backflow prevention device for protection of the supply system.

**[RB] Water-Resistive Barrier**

A material behind an *exterior wall* covering that is intended to resist liquid water that has penetrated behind the exterior covering from further intruding into the *exterior wall* assembly.

**Water Service Pipe**

The outside pipe from the water main or other source of potable water supply to the water distribution system inside the building, terminating at the service valve.

**Water Supply System**

The water service pipe, the water-distributing pipes and the necessary connecting pipes, fittings, control valves and appurtenances in or adjacent to the building or premises.

**Wet Vent**

A vent that receives the discharge of wastes from other fixtures.

**Whole-House Mechanical Ventilation System**

An exhaust system, supply system, or combination thereof that is designed to mechanically exchange indoor air for outdoor air where operating continuously or through a programmed intermittent schedule to satisfy the whole-house ventilation rate.

See also Section R202 of the *Florida Building Code, Energy Conservation*.

**[RB] Windborne Debris Region**

Areas within hurricane-prone regions located in accordance with one of the following:

1. Within 1 mile (1.61 km) of the coastal mean high water line where the ultimate design wind speed,  $V_{ult}$ , is 130 mph (58 m/s) or greater.
2. In areas where the ultimate design wind speed,  $V_{ult}$ , is 140 mph (63.6 m/s) or greater; or Hawaii.

**[RB] Winder**

A tread with nonparallel edges.

**[RB] Wood Structural Panel**

A panel manufactured from veneers; or wood strands or wafers; bonded together with waterproof synthetic resins or other suitable bonding systems. Examples of wood structural panels are plywood, OSB or composite panels.

**[RB] Yard**

An open space, other than a court, unobstructed from the ground to the sky, except where specifically provided by this code, on the *lot* on which a building is situated.